

RRB NTPC 2026

Non-Technical Popular Categories — 12th Pass (UG) Posts
Complete Syllabus & Exam Pattern

Conducting body: Railway Recruitment Board (RRB) | Official website: <https://www.rrbapply.gov.in>

Exam Overview

Examination	RRB NTPC 2026 (Non-Technical Popular Categories)
Conducting Body	Railway Recruitment Board (RRB)
Mode of Exam	Online (Computer-Based Test)
Selection Process	CBT 1 (screening) → CBT 2 (merit) → Typing Skill Test / Computer-Based Aptitude Test (for certain posts) → Document Verification
Negative Marking	1/3 mark deducted for every wrong answer (applies to both CBT 1 and CBT 2)
Question Type	Objective-type Multiple Choice Questions only (no descriptive paper)
Official Website	https://www.rrbapply.gov.in

The recruitment process involves two Computer-Based Tests. The syllabus is largely the same for both stages, but the difficulty level and question weightage increase significantly in CBT 2. **CBT 1 is purely qualifying** — it only shortlists candidates. The **final merit is based on CBT 2** and the subsequent skill tests, where applicable.

Stage 1 — CBT 1 Exam Pattern

CBT 1 is a screening test. The marks are used only to shortlist candidates for CBT 2 and are not added to the final merit list.

Subject	No. of Questions
General Awareness	40
Mathematics	30
General Intelligence & Reasoning	30
Total	100

Duration: 90 minutes (120 minutes for PwBD candidates using a scribe).

Stage 2 — CBT 2 Exam Pattern

CBT 2 is the merit-deciding stage — the final selection is heavily influenced by your CBT 2 performance.

Subject	No. of Questions
General Awareness	50

Subject	No. of Questions
Mathematics	35
General Intelligence & Reasoning	35
Total	120

Duration: 90 minutes (120 minutes for PwBD candidates using a scribe).

Note: The syllabus topics are the same for both 12th-pass and graduate posts. Only the difficulty level of CBT 2 is higher for graduate-level posts.

Detailed Syllabus

The syllabus is designed to assess logical skills, mathematical knowledge and awareness of current affairs. The three modules below apply to both CBT 1 and CBT 2.

1. Mathematics

Requires constant practice and speed.

- Number System, Decimals and Fractions
- LCM and HCF
- Ratio and Proportion
- Percentage
- Mensuration
- Time and Work
- Time and Distance
- Simple Interest and Compound Interest
- Profit and Loss
- Elementary Algebra
- Geometry
- Trigonometry

2. General Intelligence and Reasoning

Focuses on your analytical abilities.

- Analogies
- Completion of Number and Alphabetical Series
- Coding and Decoding
- Mathematical Operations
- Similarities and Differences
- Relationships
- Analytical Reasoning
- Syllogism
- Jumbling
- Venn Diagrams
- Puzzle
- Data Sufficiency
- Statement and Conclusion
- Decision Making

3. General Awareness

The most scoring section — covers a wide range of topics.

- Current Events of National and International Importance
- Games and Sports
- Art and Culture of India
- Indian Literature
- Monuments and Places of India
- General Science and Life Science (up to 10th CBSE standard)
- History of India and the Freedom Struggle
- Physical, Social and Economic Geography of India and the World
- Indian Polity and Governance
- Indian Economy

Note: General Science carries roughly 10 questions in CBT 1 (within the General Awareness section), covering basic Physics, Chemistry and Biology at the 10th-class level.

Negative Marking & Timing

Aspect	Detail
Negative Marking	1/3 of the marks assigned to a question is deducted for every wrong answer. Applies to both CBT 1 and CBT 2.
Standard Duration	90 minutes per test
PwBD with Scribe	120 minutes per test
Why it matters	Accuracy is as important as speed. Practise timed mock tests so you neither rush into wrong answers nor leave questions unattempted.

Skill Tests (For Certain Posts)

Both CBTs are fully objective — there is no descriptive paper. After clearing CBT 2, certain posts require an additional qualifying test:

- Typing Skill Test — required for clerical / typing-based posts.
- Computer-Based Aptitude Test — required for posts such as Station Master and Traffic Assistant.

Preparation Tips

- Review the syllabus first — go thoroughly through the latest CBT 1 and CBT 2 syllabus so you know exactly what to focus on.
- Create a timetable — divide your time wisely across all three subjects, and build in daily revision and mock tests.
- Practise with papers — solve previous year papers and take regular mock tests to build accuracy and speed and get familiar with question types.
- Analyse your performance — review every mock test and spend extra time on the topics where you keep making mistakes.
- Focus on revision — set aside dedicated time to reinforce key concepts and formulas, especially in General Awareness and Mathematics.
- Stay updated — read newspapers or follow reliable sources daily for the current-affairs part of General Awareness; pay attention to static GK such as world organisations, headquarters and important Indian acts.

This document is a study reference compiled for RRB NTPC 2026 aspirants. Exam patterns and syllabus details are subject to change — always verify against the official notification on <https://www.rrbapply.gov.in> before relying on them.